



Personal Prayer Space

Write your own reflection or prayer to God about trusting His Word and His authority in your life:



Word Study

- **Abigail (Hebrew: אֲבִיגַיִל – “Avigayil”)** — “My father’s joy” or “source of joy.” Her character embodied the beauty of her name; she became a channel of peace and joy even in chaos.
- **Nabal (Hebrew: נָבָל – “Nabal”)** — “Foolish” or “senseless.” His actions reflected his name, showing how arrogance blinds us to wisdom and leads to destruction.
- **Scapegoat (Hebrew: עֶזְרָאֵל – “Azazel”)** — From Leviticus 16, referring to the goat released into the wilderness carrying the sins of the people. Symbolically, Abigail bore the “guilt” of her household to intercede for peace.
- **Foresight** — Spiritual sensitivity that anticipates and prepares for what God is revealing ahead of time.

Write one line about where you need *foresight* right now:



Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with _____ and faith, not fear.
2. Nabal’s pride led to his _____.
3. David praised God for Abigail’s _____.
4. Abigail’s wisdom prevented _____ and brought peace.

(Check answers in the Appendix)

BM3 — Lesson 3: The Centurion

Faith That Commands Results



Theme: Trusting Jesus' Word



Background Text: Matt 8:5–13; Luke 7:1–10



Key Verse: Matt 8:10 (WEB)

“When Jesus heard it, he marveled, and said... ‘Most certainly I tell you, I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel.’”



Faith that trusts the Word, not the circumstances.



Appetizer – The Power of the Word, Matt 8:5–8

⁵ When he came into Capernaum, a centurion came to him, asking him for help, ⁶ saying, “Lord, my servant lies in the house paralyzed, grievously tormented.” ⁷ Jesus said to him, “**I will come and heal him.**” The centurion answered, ‘Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed.’

The centurion didn’t ask Jesus for a visit—he asked Him for a word. He believed that one word from Jesus could travel farther and work faster than any doctor, medicine, or ritual.

Faith is not about proximity—it’s about posture. The centurion knew Jesus didn’t have to be physically present to be powerfully effective. True belief doesn’t demand evidence; it simply trusts the Word.



Reflection Question

Have you ever believed God for something without needing to “see” how He would do it?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Faith That Understands Authority Matt 8:8–9a

The centurion answered, “Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed. For I also am a man under authority, having under myself soldiers. I tell this one, ‘Go,’ and he goes...”

He didn’t need Jesus to walk to his house. He understood that if Jesus had authority, then His word was enough—even from a distance. Real faith doesn’t always need a physical sign. It trusts that when Jesus speaks, it’s already done.

CST Thought

Humility is the bridge to divine help. The centurion had status, money, and influence—but he laid all of that down at Jesus’ feet. Faith is strongest when pride is silent.

Reflection Question

How does humility open the door for faith to operate in your life?

Bite 2 – Faith That Amazed Jesus, Matt 8:10, 13

¹⁰ When Jesus heard it, he marveled and said to those who followed, “Most certainly I tell you, I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel. ¹³ Jesus said to the centurion, “Go your way. Let it be done for you as you have believed.” His servant was healed in that hour.

When he looked at Jesus, he recognized heavenly authority at work: the same power that governs sickness, distance, and timing. Jesus was amazed at this man’s faith. Not because he was perfect or religious, but because he believed Jesus’ word was enough.

Author’s Commentary

Your background doesn’t limit your faith. Jesus is moved by trust, not titles. Aligning with the Great “I AM” starts with your words. Think about it: in the very first chapter of the Bible, the Creator didn’t use hands or tools to build the universe—He spoke ten times, and reality shifted.

Proverbs 18:21 tells us that life and death are held in the power of the tongue, and Isaiah 55:11 explains the authority behind that release. The Centurion understood the assignment. He knew that while "laying on of hands" might make people feel better, the real work happens when a word is released. He didn't need a ritual; he just needed a command. That word ricochets through eternity until it hits the target.

In the modern world, we say "Say Less"—because when you are walking in strong faith, you don't need a long speech. That level of trust was the "IT" factor that turned his request into a power move.

He believed that if Jesus spoke, creation itself had to respond. He saw that Jesus carried a higher command than Rome—kingdom authority.

Reflection Question

When you pray, do you believe the words you speak *in Jesus' name* carry that same delegated authority?

Bite 3 – The Sent Word, John 1:1,14

1 In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ¹⁴ And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.

The centurion had many reasons why he didn't believe Jesus needed to physically come, but Emmanuel, was happy someone caught the revelation. When he sent the word, he sent HIMSELF, because he was and is the Word! Whew...

He sent grace, and the truth that he was a healer, and a provider. In the past we use to send notes or mail by men on horseback, or by train... Now we have devices that allow us to send our thoughts via recorded files or text across oceans and time zones. They did not have electricity and the internet but they had faith and the Son of God walking with them...who was God's word wrapped in clay. Since he is wholeness and healing ...he just released it with his servant's recovery in mind... and in an hour he was well again!

Reflection Question

Who could you be praying for or believing for, like the centurion did for his servant?

Dessert – Beyond a Resume - A Word Is Enough

Jesus didn't respond to the wealth, the power, or the "good guy" resume. He responded to a heart in need. Emmanuel—God with us—met a level of faith that understood Christ's authority isn't limited by physical presence. The Centurion knew that the Will and the Word of God were enough to cross any threshold and restore what was broken.

When we say "Amen," we are literally saying **"It is so."** It's the moment we stop looking for a physical sign and come into total agreement with what God has already spoken. The Centurion didn't need a visit; he just needed a Word. He knew that once the Word was released, the shift was already final.

What would shift in your prayer life if you trusted what God said more than what you see?

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight together teach us that authority in prayer isn't about volume or visibility—it's about confidence in the Word of God.
 - Humility positions us to receive what pride would block.
 - Real faith does not require God to "prove it" first; it rests in what He has already spoken.
 - When you recognize Jesus' authority, you can walk in your own God-given authority with boldness and peace.
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Prayer

"Lord Jesus, thank You for the centurion's example of simple, strong faith. Help me to trust Your Word more than what I see and to pray with confidence in Your authority, not my own strength. Teach me to stay humble, to believe that when You speak, things change. In Your name, amen."



Word Study

- **Centurion (Latin: *Centurio*)** – A Roman officer over about one hundred soldiers; represents leadership through discipline, obedience, and order.
- **Authority (Greek: *Exousia*, ἐξουσία)** – Permission and delegated power; the right to act. Jesus carries authority over nature, sickness, sin, and even death.
- **Faith (Greek: *Pistis*, πίστις)** – Trust, conviction, and complete reliance upon God’s truth and character.

Write a short line about where you need to trust Jesus’ authority more fully:



Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion’s faith worked even at a _____.
2. Jesus said, “I have not found anyone in Israel with such great _____.”
3. True faith doesn’t need evidence; it trusts the _____.
4. The centurion understood the power of _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

BM3 — Lesson 4: Joseph of Arimathea

Trust the Process



Theme: Faith & Foresight



Background Text : Matthew 27:57–61; John 19:38–42



Key Verse: John 19:38 (WEB)

“After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body.”

 *Faith that honors Jesus even when the story looks finished.*



Appetizer – Faith in Action, John 19:38a; Matt 27:57–58

³⁸ After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews,

⁵⁷ When the even was come, there came a rich man of Arimathaea, named Joseph, who also himself was Jesus' disciple: ⁵⁸ He went to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be delivered

Joseph of Arimathea was a rich man, a respected council member, and a quiet follower of Jesus. When many had run away in fear, he stepped forward in love and courage. He went straight to Pilate and asked for the body of the crucified Christ—a bold, risky request that publicly tied his name to Jesus at the very moment things looked the worst.

Even in loss, faith moves us to act in honor. Joseph’s decision to claim Jesus’ body was not loud or flashy, but it was a quiet and powerful display of devotion when many others had fled.



Reflection Question

When have you had to act on your faith quietly but boldly, even when others were afraid to stand?
